MiD Marketers in Demand

Washington Speakers Bureau

MARKETING ROADMAP

December 16, 2025

Agenda

- Overview
  - Target Market
  - Brand Positioning & Messaging
  - Products & Solutions
  - Competition
- Roadmap
  - Goals
  - Quarterly Initiatives
  - Plan

Overview

In this initial section, we lay the groundwork for a successful partnership, setting the stage for a marketing roadmap that is both dynamic and results-driven.

We outline the critical components that will shape our journey towards achieving your business objectives.

Here are the core components:

- **Delivering Results through a Six-Phase Process:** At the heart of our roadmap is a meticulously crafted six-phase process that Marketers in Demand utilizes to guarantee tangible results. This process, honed through years of experience, serves as a roadmap, guiding us through the various stages of market analysis, roadmap formulation, and execution. It is a blueprint that ensures every step we undertake is grounded in data and aligned with your overarching business goals.

- **Balancing Long-Term and Short-Term Objectives:** Crafting a roadmap that focuses on both long-term and short-term objectives is a constant balancing act. And that's why we take deliberate steps to monitor short-term success while building with a big picture in mind. With a series of goals, structured meetings, and real-time reporting and analytics, your team has the unique opportunity to deliver in the short and long term.

- **Your Marketing "Machine":** Central to our approach is the marketing "machine" - a dedicated team designed to not only provide strategic direction, but deliver on the plan as well. The team includes three primary roles: 1) Strategists, 2) Specialists, and 3) Production.

With these key ingredients, we plan to work alongside your company to deliver on the long-term/annual goals while delivering on specific priorities for the quarter.

How do we deliver results?

Quarterly

Monthly

1 Research

- Quantitative and qualitative research (brand, content and website assessment)
- Channel analysis (paid, SEO, social)
- Tech stack analysis

2 Alignment

- Discussions around desired goals and business outcomes
- Success metric definition
- Insights from research and existing benchmarks
- Pinpoint priorities

3 Roadmap

- Document current marketing strategy
- Competition
- Performance reporting
- Develop goals
- Establish quarterly initiatives
- Confirm budget

4 Foundation

- Plans for designated channels
- Updates to brand, web, and content plans
- Performance reporting enhancements

5 Execution

- Set up, produce, launch and manage channels
- Produce assets to support owned experiences and campaigns
- Real-time view into progress

6 Analysis

- Review results and compare to goals
- Discuss results in Board & Analytics meetings
- Determine next steps for growth

Marketing research

- **Multi-Model Research Approach:** Utilized multiple Large Language Models (LLMs) for deep, comprehensive industry insights, forecasts, and strategic recommendations.
- **Extensive Data Scraping:** Analyzed competitors' websites, organic search rankings, domain authority, and paid media ads from Google, LinkedIn, and YouTube. Used n8n to automate the data extraction process and consolidate information for the research report.
- **Customer Insights Development:** Identified key customer behaviors, decision-making criteria, pain points, and price sensitivity to inform targeted marketing strategies. Key activities included analyzing industry publications and major industry websites.
- **Actionable Strategic Insights:** Conducted qualitative analysis and evaluated your organization against the competition.

Access Research

Target market

In the initial phase of the strategic process, we zero in on the cornerstone of any successful marketing roadmap: the target market.

This section is dedicated to dissecting and understanding the profile of your ideal customer. It's a deep dive into the psyche, behaviors, and preferences of the individuals or businesses that constitute your potential customers.

Here, we unravel the layers that define your audience, setting the stage for a marketing roadmap that resonates with the exact people you want to attract.

The components of this section are as follows:

- **Understanding the Customers:** We need to understand who we want to connect with before we craft any message or launch a campaign. One of the key building blocks of understanding your target market is pinpointing the types of accounts/people that make the most sense. In this section of the roadmap, we identify the ideal types of customers you want to attract. We pinpoint specific demographics and other key criteria to help us narrow in on the individuals we want to engage.

- **Documenting Specific Customers:** Identifying the types of people to target is just a piece of the puzzle. In this section, we take it a step further and drilldown to individual prospects. This involves a comprehensive analysis of psychographic and behavioral traits. It's about painting a vivid picture of your audience, understanding their needs, preferences, and what success means to them.

Every marketing roadmap starts with the customer. Once we build a solid understanding of the customer, we can create owned experiences and amplify messages across a variety of channels.

Ideal target account

Enterprise Companies with Centralized Event Teams

Fortune 500 corporations with dedicated event organizations host 20+ annual engagements. They manage diverse speaker budgets from $15K to $250K+ and need bureau partners who understand their culture, deliver strategic recommendations, and support complex event portfolios across multiple business units.

Location	North America
Industry	Multi-industry (Financial Services, Technology, Consumer Goods, Professional Services)
Revenue:	$5B - $50B+
Employees:	10.000 - 100.000+
Technologies:	Salesforce, Cvent, HubSpot, Workday, SAP Concur

Ideal customer

Michelle Torres | VP of Corporate Meetings & Events @ MasterCard

Thinks

She needs speakers who anchor major initiatives and drive real impact. Her team's success depends on matching the right speaker to each audience. She worries about maintaining relationships with proven speakers while discovering fresh voices.

Says

"I need a partner who understands our culture and strategic priorities." "Can you show me speakers who've worked with financial services audiences?" "We anchor our leadership summit around one keynote—it has to be perfect."

Sees

She sees dozens of speaker proposals monthly. She sees her peers at other Fortune 500s facing similar challenges. She sees internal stakeholders with competing priorities. She sees budget pressure despite high-profile events.

Pains

Michelle struggles to maintain personalized relationships when managing 25+ annual events. She faces disconnected communication with bureaus between bookings. She deals with last-minute speaker changes and availability issues.

Feels

Michelle feels pressure to deliver memorable experiences across 25+ events annually. She feels confident when her bureau partner knows her business. She feels frustrated when vendors treat each booking as transactional.

Does

Michelle plans events 8-10 months ahead. She builds relationships with bureau partners who deliver consistently. She evaluates speakers based on audience fit and past performance.

Hears

"We need someone who can speak to our transformation journey." "Marketing wants a big name; L&D wants practical content." "Our budget got cut but expectations stayed the same."

Goals

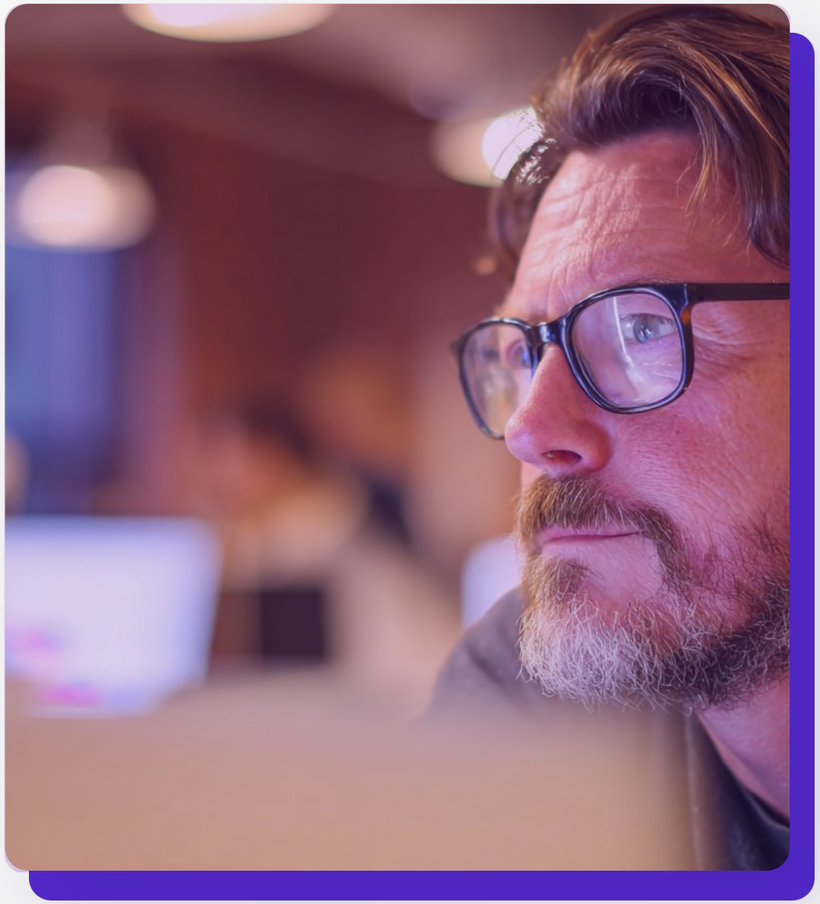
Michelle aims to build strategic partnerships with bureaus who know her business. She wants consistent communication and proactive recommendations.

Ideal target account

Financial Services Learning & Development Organizations

Banks and investment firms investing heavily in leadership development, client experiences, and corporate training. They require speakers who understand financial services dynamics and deliver content that transforms teams and engages high-value clients.

Location	North America (Major Financial Centers: New York, Chicago, San Francisco, Charlotte, Boston)
Industry	Financial Services (Banking, Investment Management, Insurance, Wealth Management)
Revenue:	$2B - $100B+
Employees:	5,000 - 50,000+
Technologies:	Salesforce Financial Services Cloud, Workday, SAP SuccessFactors, Cornerstone OnDemand, Zoom Events



Ideal customer

David Chen | Director of Leadership Development @ Fidelity Investments

Thinks

David knows great speakers drive culture change and leadership excellence. He believes content must connect to real financial services challenges. He considers how speakers will handle sophisticated, skeptical audiences.

Says

"Our executives won't engage with generic leadership content." "We need someone who understands regulatory pressures and market volatility." "Can we capture video for our learning management system?"

Sees

He sees competitors investing heavily in thought leadership and client experiences. He sees internal compliance teams scrutinizing content and contracts. He sees budgets allocated across multiple business units.

Pains

Navigates complex approval processes and contract negotiations. He manages strict compliance and legal requirements around content and recordings. He balances the need for industry-specific expertise with engaging presentation skills.

Feels

David feels accountable for developing next-generation leaders. He feels cautious about speakers who lack financial industry credibility. He feels energized when speakers deliver actionable frameworks.

Does

David books speakers 6-12 months in advance for flagship programs. He vets speakers through reference calls with similar firms. He negotiates contract terms carefully, especially video and recording rights.

Hears

"We need speakers who've advised financial institutions, not just spoken to them." "Legal redlined the recording clause again." "Our top clients expect world-class speakers at our summit."

Goals

David wants to partner with bureaus who understand financial services culture and constraints. He seeks speakers who blend industry expertise with compelling delivery.

Ideal target account

Professional Association Annual Conference Planners

Membership organizations hosting industry conferences and regional events that educate, inspire, and connect professionals. They value speakers who understand their community, deliver relevant insights, and create memorable experiences that drive member engagement and satisfaction.

Location	United States
Industry	Professional Associations (Healthcare, HR, Industry Trade Groups, Executive Networks)
Revenue (AUM):	$10M - $250M
Employees:	50 - 500
Technologies:	Nonprofit, Wild Apricot, Higher Logic, Cvent, Personify

Ideal customer

Jennifer Martinez | Director of Conferences & Events @ SHRM (Society for Human Resource Management)

Thinks

Jennifer knows the keynote speaker sets the tone for the entire conference. She considers how to balance big-name appeal with budget constraints. She evaluates which speakers will resonate with diverse member demographics.

Says

"Our members expect speakers who understand HR challenges firsthand." "We need someone who can engage 2,000 people in a ballroom." "Last year's speaker scored 4.8 out of 5; we need to maintain that standard."

Sees

She sees members comparing her conference to competitors' events. She sees budget spreadsheets with limited flexibility. She sees volunteer board members with strong opinions. She sees post-event surveys that directly impact her performance review.

Pains

Jennifer faces pressure to drive conference registrations through speaker announcements. She struggles to find speakers who deliver both credibility and engagement at her price point.

Feels

Jennifer feels pride in delivering value to members who invest time and money to attend. She feels pressure to match or exceed previous years' speaker quality. She feels responsible for using member dues wisely.

Does

Jennifer plans the annual conference 12-18 months in advance. She presents speaker options to executive committees for approval. She negotiates within fixed budget parameters. She collects member feedback and session ratings.

Hears

"Can we get someone who's been featured on major podcasts or TED?" "The board wants a name that will drive registrations." "Members loved the interactive format last year." "We need diversity in our speaker lineup."

Goals

Jennifer aims to deliver exceptional speaker experiences that drive member satisfaction scores. She wants bureau partners who respect her budget and understand her audience.

Ideal target account

Corporate Marketing Event Strategy Teams

Marketing departments orchestrating customer conferences, sales kickoffs, and brand experiences that drive business results. They seek speakers who elevate brand positioning, engage audiences authentically, and deliver content that aligns with corporate messaging and revenue goals.

Location	North America
Industry	Technology, Professional Services, Manufacturing, Healthcare, B2B Services
Revenue:	$500M - $10B
Employees:	2,000 - 20,000
Technologies:	HubSpot, Marketo, Salesforce Marketing Cloud, 6sense, ON24, Splash

Ideal customer

Sarah Williams | VP of Marketing Events & Experiences @ Deloitte

Thinks

Sarah knows speakers must reinforce brand themes and strategic messaging. She considers how speaker content will resonate on social media and in follow-up campaigns. She evaluates speakers' ability to engage C-level audiences and prospects.

Says

"Our customer conference needs a speaker who embodies innovation and transformation." "Can you show me speakers who've worked with B2B audiences?"

Sees

She sees competitors creating compelling customer experiences. She sees internal pressure to demonstrate marketing ROI. She sees sales teams looking to marketing for inspiration and momentum.

Pains

Sarah struggles to find speakers who understand B2B dynamics and corporate contexts. She navigates competing stakeholder opinions on speaker selection. She faces pressure to demonstrate clear ROI from event investments.

Feels

Sarah feels accountable for creating experiences that drive pipeline and revenue. She feels confident when speakers understand her business objectives. She feels anxious when speakers seem scripted or disconnected.

Does

Sarah books speakers 6-9 months before major events. She collaborates with sales leadership on kickoff speaker selection. She creates detailed briefs outlining audience profiles and business objectives.

Hears

"We need someone who can fire up the sales team before a critical quarter." "Our customers want forward-thinking perspectives, not sales pitches." "Can the speaker mention our new platform without making it feel promotional?"

Goals

Sarah aims to create event experiences that drive measurable business outcomes. She wants speakers who enhance brand positioning and thought leadership.

Brand positioning & messaging

Your ideal customers have a lot of choices in the market. So establishing a distinct and resonant brand story is more than just a task; it's a crucial part of everything we develop down the road.

This section is where we craft the narrative of your brand, a story that not only distinguishes you in the marketplace but deeply resonates with your target audience.

We leverage the *Storybrand* framework and use it to carve out a unique space for your brand in the minds of your customers.

Here's what this section encompasses:

- **Understanding the Character:** At the heart of your brand's story is the primary character (or "hero").

  The hero is your ideal customer.

- **Crafting the Story:** Once the character is outlined, we use techniques to establish your brand as the guide on their journey. We uncover how your brand plays a role in transforming your customer from what state to another.

Ultimately, your brand's story helps:

- Provide a human connection
- Highlight differences between your brand and competitors (or alternatives)
- Build trust and loyalty
- Establish a foundation for all communication (owned experiences and messages amplified in channels such as ABM, Paid, Social, and SEO

Washington Speakers Bureau Brand Canvas

Your Customer

Event leaders want the perfect speaker who delivers memorable experiences, aligns with their strategic objectives, and resonates deeply with their specific audience.

Has a Challenge

Villain: The transactional approach to speaker booking that treats every engagement as one-and-done rather than building strategic relationships.

External problem: Finding speakers who truly fit their audience, coordinating across multiple stakeholders, managing diverse budgets and event types.

Internal problem: Fear of selecting a speaker who doesn't connect with their audience, feeling abandoned between bookings.

Philosophical: Every event represents an investment in people and culture. Audiences deserve speakers who understand their challenges and deliver content that creates lasting impact.

Finds Your Company

Empathy: Washington Speakers Bureau understands the pressure of delivering flawless events across diverse portfolios. We know you're coordinating multiple stakeholders, managing tight timelines, and seeking partners who proactively support your success, not just respond to requests.

Authority: With 45+ years of experience, 200 exclusive speakers, and trusted relationships with Fortune 500 companies and leading associations, WSB has placed more than 100k speakers in 67 countries around the world.

You Give Them a Plan

Process: WSB provides strategic consultation to understand your audience and objectives, delivers curated speaker recommendations based on proven fit, handles all logistics seamlessly, and maintains proactive communication throughout your event calendar—not just during bookings.

Agreement or guarantee: We commit to relationship-focused partnerships that grow with your needs. You'll receive strategic recommendations tailored to your organization, ongoing communication between events, and dedicated support that treats every booking as part of your larger story.

You Call Them to Action

Direct: Partner with Washington Speakers Bureau for your next speaking engagement. Get a custom proposal.

Transitional or secondary: Explore our exclusive speaker roster or sign up for our newsletter.

To Experience Success

- Perfect speaker-audience alignment that drives engagement and business results
- Strategic partnership that understands your culture and anticipates your needs
- Access to world-class speakers who anchor corporate initiatives and create lasting impact
- Proactive recommendations that introduce you to speakers before you even know you need them

And Avoid Failure

- Wasting budget on speakers who don't connect with your specific audience
- Last-minute availability crises and scrambling for replacements
- Transactional relationships that leave you unsupported until your next booking request

You Help Transform Your Customer

From: Managing speaker bookings transactionally with uncertainty about selection, feeling unsupported between events, and lacking a partner who truly understands their organizational needs.

To: Strategic partnership with confidence in every booking decision, proactive support throughout the year, and a trusted guide who knows their culture and delivers consistent excellence.

Products & solutions

It's important to document how you help your ideal customers overcome their challenges.

This section delineates the array of products and solutions your brand offers, casting a spotlight on their potential to transform the customer from a negative to a positive state.

Central to this section is the comprehensive Products & Solutions Matrix, a tool designed to offer a clear, concise overview of each product's role in the customer's journey.

This matrix is structured to provide insights into:

- **Product:** A detailed description of each product, highlighting its unique features and capabilities.
- **Specific Challenges the Product Helps Overcome:** This attribute identifies the major pain points customers face and why the product exists.
- **How the Product Provides a Picture of Success:** Here, we paint a vivid picture of the potential success that customers can achieve through the utilization of the product, fostering a positive and aspirational outlook.
- **How the Product Helps Avoid Failure:** This segment focuses on the preventative aspects of the product, illustrating how it can help users sidestep common pitfalls and failures, thereby securing a smoother path to their goals.

By taking the time to document products in this way, we set up a foundation for messaging in ABM, Paid Media, SEO, and Social channels.

Products & solutions matrix

Product/Solution	Helps Overcome these Challenges	Provides this Picture of Success	Helps Avoid this Failure
Strategic Speaker Partnership	Event leaders struggle with transactional bureau relationships that leave them unsupported between bookings. They lack partners who understand their organizational culture, anticipate their needs across 20+ annual events, and provide proactive recommendations. They coordinate multiple stakeholders while managing diverse budgets and objectives without strategic guidance throughout their event calendar.	Your bureau partner knows your business, proactively recommends speakers before you even ask, and maintains consistent communication year-round. You receive strategic consultation that aligns speakers with corporate initiatives, builds on past successes, and introduces you to emerging talent that fits your specific culture and audience needs.	Avoid last-minute scrambling for speakers, missed opportunities to anchor corporate initiatives around compelling content, and transactional relationships that treat every booking as a one-off transaction. Prevent the frustration of explaining your organization's needs repeatedly to partners who never truly understand your business.
Exclusive Speaker Access	Organizations face limited access to world-class thought leaders and proven speakers who can anchor major initiatives. They compete for availability of top-tier talent, struggle to discover speakers before they become oversaturated, and lack direct relationships with speakers who can customize content for their specific needs and deliver consistent excellence.	You gain priority access to 200 exclusive speakers—including bestselling authors, Fortune 500 executives, and renowned thought leaders—who work closely with WSB to customize content. You book speakers who align perfectly with your objectives, deliver exceptional audience engagement, and create lasting impact that drives your strategic initiatives forward across all events.	Avoid settling for second-choice speakers due to availability constraints, booking speakers who deliver generic content that fails to resonate, and missing opportunities to secure emerging thought leaders before they become inaccessible or prohibitively expensive for your budget range.

Products & solutions matrix

Product/Solution	Helps Overcome these Challenges	Provides this Picture of Success	Helps Avoid this Failure
Custom Speaker Curation & Topic Expertise	Event planners struggle to find speakers who address specific themes, industry challenges, or audience demographics beyond big-name celebrities. They waste time researching hundreds of options, lack confidence in speaker quality for specialized topics, and need guidance matching speakers to diverse audience types across their event portfolio with varying budgets and objectives.	You receive curated speaker recommendations tailored to your specific topic, audience, and budget—whether you need AI experts for healthcare audiences, leadership speakers for financial services, or motivational voices for sales kickoffs. Every recommendation comes with insights on why this speaker fits your needs, backed by proven performance with similar audiences.	Avoid booking speakers who miss the mark on content relevance, wasting budget on mismatched talent that doesn't connect with your specific audience, and the disappointment of generic presentations that could have been delivered to any industry or demographic without customization or impact.
Full-Service Speaker Event Logistics & Coordination	Organizations manage complex speaker logistics across multiple events, coordinate travel and contracts, navigate legal and compliance requirements, and handle last-minute changes without dedicated support. They lack streamlined processes for video rights, speaker briefings, and post-event coordination while managing internal stakeholder expectations and competing priorities throughout the planning cycle.	You experience seamless execution from initial consultation through post-event follow-up. WSB handles all contracts, travel logistics, speaker briefings, and coordination with your internal teams. Your speakers arrive prepared, deliver exceptional presentations, and you receive support managing any last-minute adjustments—all while maintaining clear communication with your stakeholders.	Avoid contract disputes and compliance issues, last-minute speaker cancellations without backup options, logistics failures that create day-of-event chaos, and the frustration of coordinating complex requirements alone across multiple business units and stakeholder groups with competing demands.

Competition

A well-rounded marketing roadmap is built not only on the strengths and offerings of your own organization but also on a profound understanding of the movements and positions of competitors in the market.

Even though the competition won't drive decisions we make, it can inform how we construct specific campaigns or implement various tactics.

This section is dedicated to offering a succinct yet insightful glimpse into the key players who share the market space with your brand, providing a vantage point to craft strategies that are both informed and adaptive.

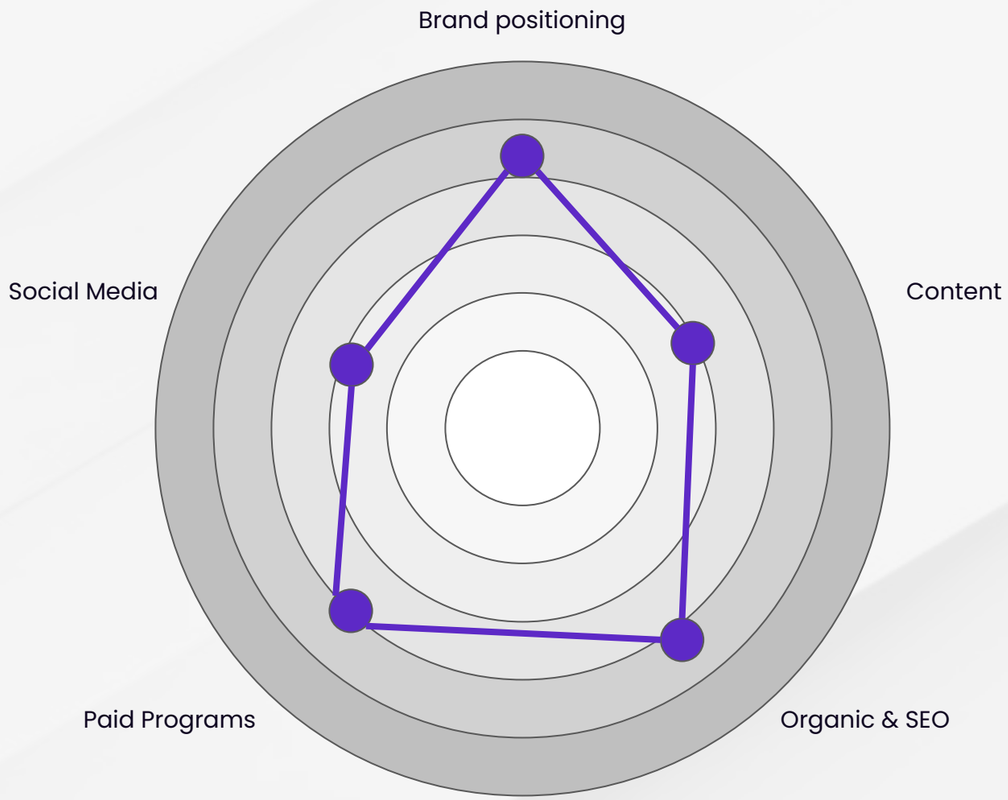
While this section doesn't delve deep into a comprehensive competitive analysis, it serves as a vital tool to identify and monitor significant competitors in the market.

By keeping a close eye on these entities, we can glean valuable insights into market trends, customer preferences, and potential areas of collaboration or differentiation.

In this section, we present how each competitor tracks along five distinct dimensions, including:

- Organic search & SEO
- Content
- Paid media
- Social media
- Brand positioning & messaging

All American Speakers

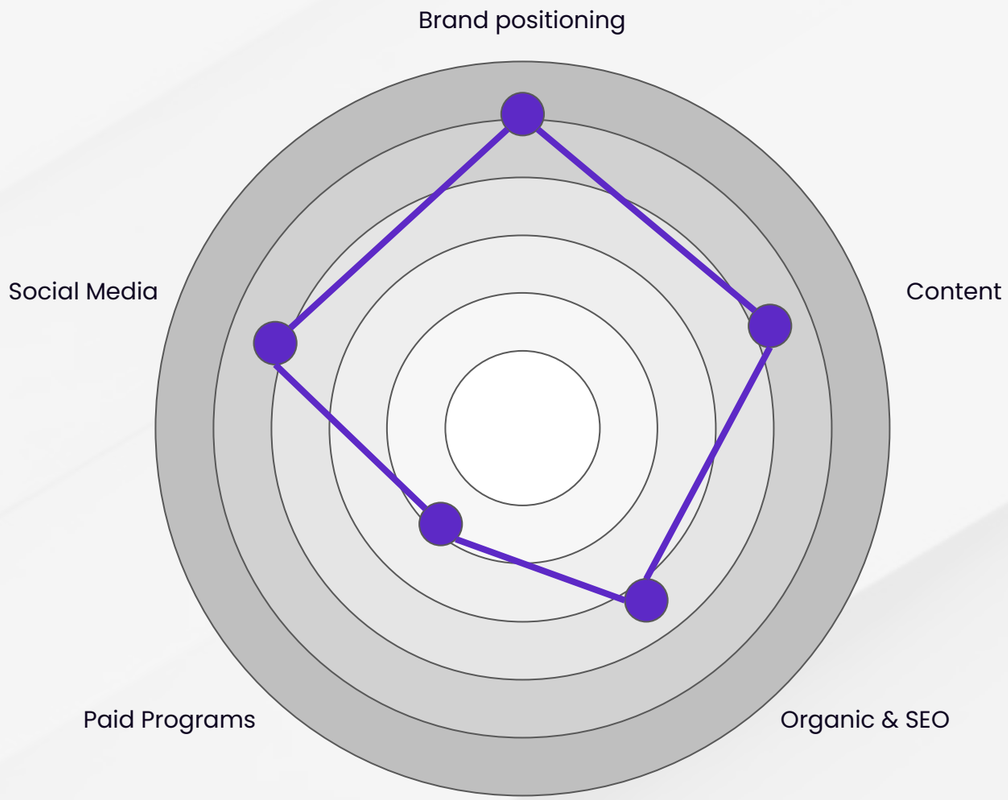


All American Speakers leads specialized speaker bureaus in SEO authority with Domain Authority of 58 and 9,030 linking root domains—nearly double WSB's portfolio. The full-service bureau competes directly in corporate speaking with 55 employees. However, significantly smaller social media presence and limited content marketing investment create vulnerabilities despite superior organic search performance and extensive backlink profile.

Key Insights:

- Domain Authority 58/100 highest among specialized bureaus, edges WSB's 57/100
- 9,030 linking root domains nearly 2x WSB's 4,558, superior link acquisition
- LinkedIn following 6,605 vs WSB 11,203, indicating weaker social strategy
- YouTube presence limited: 286 subscribers, 95 videos vs WSB's 2,330/607
- Overall competitive score 4.8/10, strongest in Organic SEO (6.5/10), weakest Content (3.4/10)

Big Speak

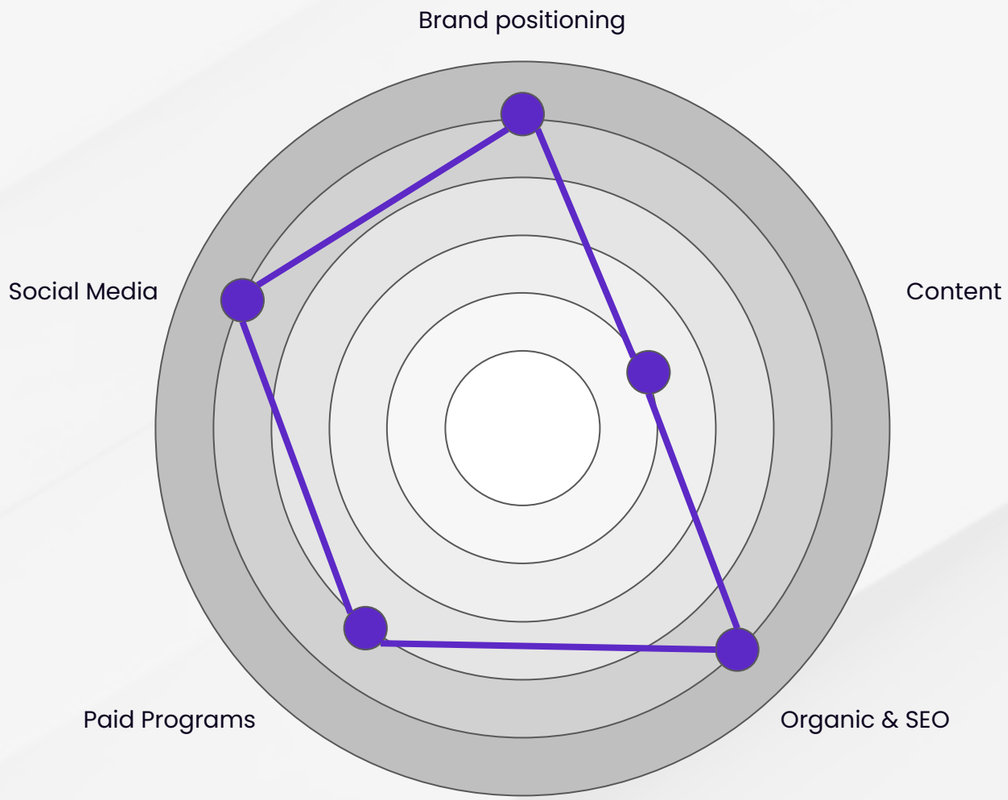


Big Speak dominates content marketing with industry's largest video library: 62,500 YouTube subscribers and 2,983 videos, creating massive SEO advantages and organic discovery opportunities. The 34-employee bureau achieved highest overall competitive score (7.0/10) through content-first strategy. Despite content leadership, Domain Authority of 54 trails WSB (57) and All American Speakers (58), suggesting content volume doesn't fully translate to technical authority.

Key Insights:

- YouTube dominance: 62,500 subscribers and 2,983 videos, 27x larger than WSB
- LinkedIn following 16,802 exceeds WSB's 11,203, 50% larger professional network
- Content Strategy scored 9.5/10, highest across all competitors and dimensions
- Domain Authority 54/100 trails WSB despite massive content investment volume
- Represents HIGH threat through content marketing but quality-over-quantity opportunity for WSB.

Creative Artists Agency (CAA)

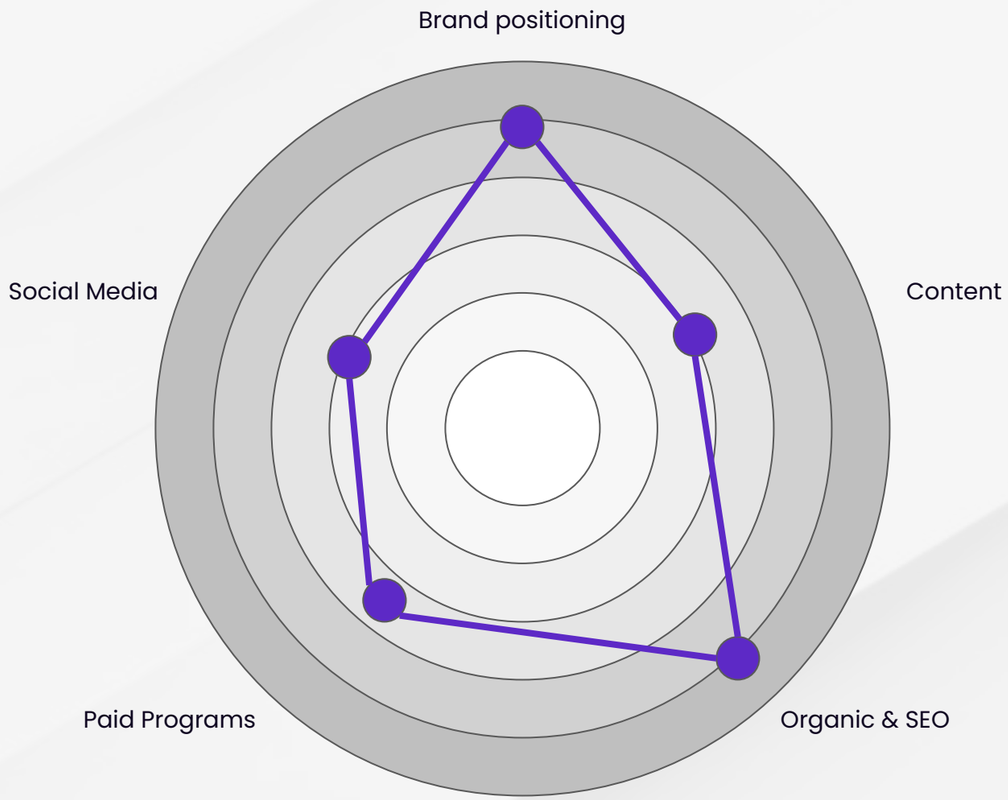


CAA operates speaker representation as one division within diversified entertainment portfolio of 1,815 employees. Achieves highest Domain Authority (65/100) and LinkedIn following (353,499) in competitive landscape, reflecting decades of entertainment industry presence. However, speaker division captures only fraction of this authority. Limited content marketing investment (75 videos, 319 YouTube subscribers) and broad entertainment focus versus corporate speaking specialization create competitive opportunities for focused bureaus.

Key Insights:

- Domain Authority 65/100 highest in competitive set, 2.6x more domains than WSB
- LinkedIn followers 353,499 dwarf all competitors, 32x larger than WSB's 11,203
- Brand Positioning scored 8.6/10, reflecting entertainment industry authority and broad recognition
- YouTube presence minimal: 319 subscribers, 75 videos despite overall brand strength
- MEDIUM threat—entertainment focus dilutes corporate speaking specialization, creating specialist positioning opportunity

The Harry Walker Agency

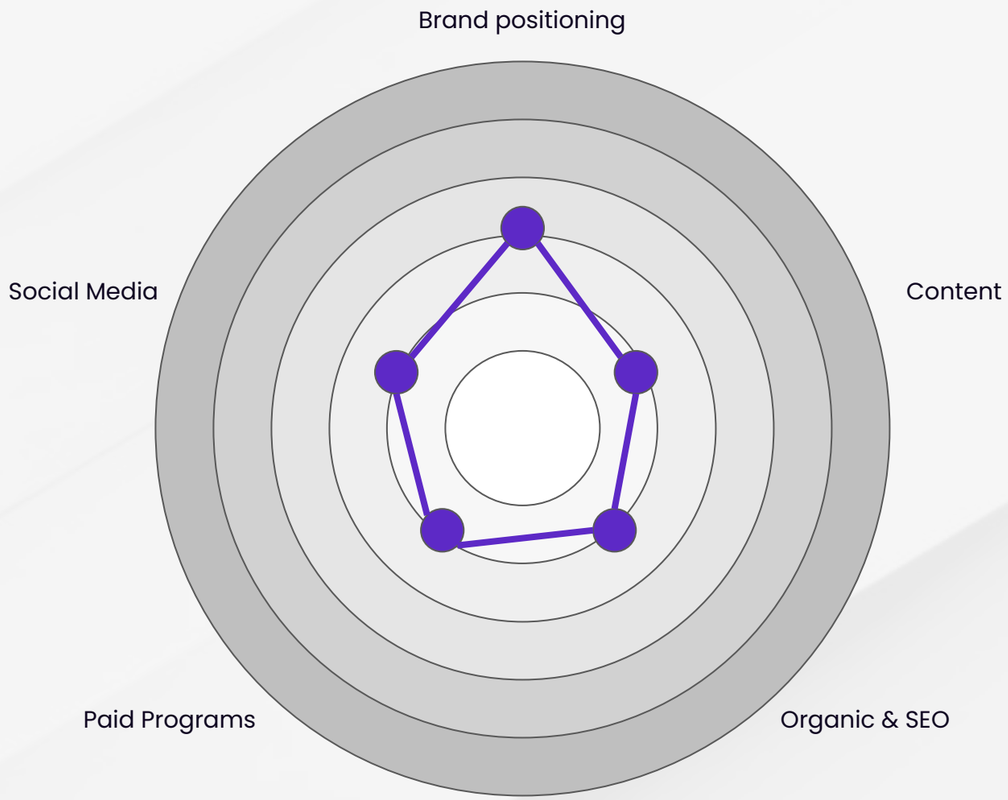


Harry Walker Agency achieves highest Domain Authority (59/100) among specialized speaker bureaus, representing premium segment with exclusive high-profile talent roster. The 50-employee agency competes directly with WSB in premium corporate speaking through quality-over-volume link acquisition strategy (4,404 domains). Moderate social media presence (5,952 LinkedIn followers, 809 YouTube subscribers) and balanced content approach position HWA as consistent premium competitor.

Key Insights:

- Domain Authority 59/100 highest among specialized bureaus, edges All American (58)
- LinkedIn following 5,952 significantly below WSB's 11,203, weaker social engagement
- YouTube presence moderate: 809 subscribers, 399 videos between WSB and Big Speak
- Overall score 5.2/10, consistent across dimensions without dominant strengths or weaknesses
- MEDIUM-HIGH threat in premium segment, opportunity in broader market coverage

United Talent Agency (UTA)



UTA Speakers operates as division of entertainment agency with 40 employees, exhibiting significant digital marketing deficits across all dimensions. Lowest Domain Authority (48/100), smallest backlink portfolio (1,424 domains), elevated spam score (13%), and minimal content presence (1 YouTube video, 64 subscribers) create substantial competitive gaps. Entertainment industry relationships provide some advantage not reflected in digital metrics, but current presence suggests limited corporate speaking focus.

Key Insights:

- Domain Authority 48/100 lowest in competitive set, only 1,424 linking domains
- LinkedIn followers 2,857 smallest among competitors, weakest professional network presence
- YouTube essentially non-existent: 64 subscribers, 1 video, no content strategy
- Overall score 3.2/10 lowest across all competitors in every dimension
- LOW threat—digital marketing deficits create validation for WSB's content investment strategy